

C10 FAMILY SUPPORT | O (MAX : 3 PT)

Intent : Support working parents and caregivers so that they are able to properly care for members of their family.

Summary : This WELL feature requires projects to offer policies and programs that facilitate childcare and family leave.

Issue : Millions of working individuals take on the role of caregiver for their children, dependents and family members; with the rapidly growing population of older adults, the number of working caregivers will continue to rise.¹ Caregivers often have to adjust their work schedules or take time off, which can significantly impact productivity due to increased absenteeism, workday interruptions and unpaid leave.² An estimated 9% of caregivers left their jobs as a result of having to balance caregiving responsibilities with work obligations.^{2,3} Employers that fail to meet the needs of caregiving employees can see reduced company productivity due to increased absenteeism, workday interruptions and unpaid leave, resulting in an annual average loss of 3.4 billion, 2.8 billion and 1.4 billion dollars, respectively.² Moreover, the loss of a loved one has been associated with higher risks of mortality, physical health problems leading to disability and hospitalization, and psychological stress like insomnia, depression and anxiety.^{4,5} Grief is also tied to productivity loss: in the U.S., grief-inducing experiences cost employers an annual average of \$75 billion in lost productivity and lost business.⁶

Solutions : By offering a range of accommodations, employers can create a supportive culture that meets the diverse needs and caretaking responsibilities of employees.³ On-site childcare that supports flexible schedules can help working parents balance family needs and work demands. Flexible work arrangements can help retain and attract employees while also improving employee productivity and engagement.³ Additionally, financial assistance, support groups and referral to community services can help individuals manage the unique challenges associated with being a caregiver.⁷ Providing employees sufficient time away from work to grieve, in addition to grief counseling and other support, can help reduce employee anxiety, depression and other health risks over time.^{4,8}

PART 1 OFFER CHILDCARE SUPPORT (MAX : 1 PT)

For All Spaces:

At least three of the following are provided for all employees:

- a. On-site childcare centers compliant with local childcare licensure regulations, or subsidies of at least 50% for off-site or at-home childcare.⁹
- b. Back-up childcare coverage (e.g., drop-in daycare, overnight childcare, in-home babysitting service, virtual childcare service) in case of unexpected events (e.g., family emergency, school closure) at no cost or subsidized by at least 50%.¹⁰
- c. School break childcare programs (e.g., center- or home-based care during school break or winter holidays)¹⁰ at no cost or subsidized by at least 50%.
- d. Policy allowing the use of paid sick leave, family leave or personal days for the care of a child.
- e. Policy allowing at least one of the following to support all employees with children:
 1. Part-time options.
 2. Work from home flexibility.
 3. Flexible schedules.⁷

PART 2 OFFER FAMILY LEAVE (MAX : 1 PT)

For All Spaces:

The project or organization makes a family leave policy available to all eligible employees that meets the following requirements:

- a. At least 12 weeks of leave during any 12-month period, paid at 75% or higher of the employee's full salary or wages, for the care of a spouse, domestic partner, child, dependent, parent, parent-in-law, grandparent, grandchild, sibling or other designated relation with a chronic or long-term serious health condition (including an illness, injury, impairment or physical or mental health condition) that involves one of the following:¹¹
 1. Inpatient care in a hospital, hospice or residential healthcare facility for conditions such as stroke, infectious disease or PTSD.
 2. Continuing treatment and/or supervision by a healthcare provider for conditions such as diabetes, asthma or cancer.
- b. The option to use paid sick leave or personal days for the care of a spouse, domestic partner, child, dependent, parent, parent-in-law, grandparent, grandchild or sibling.
- c. At least one of the following for the care of a spouse, domestic partner, child, dependent, parent, parent-in-law, grandparent, grandchild, sibling or other designated relation:
 1. Part-time options.
 2. Work from home flexibility.
 3. Flexible schedules.

PART 3 OFFER BEREAVEMENT SUPPORT (MAX : 1 PT)

For All Spaces:

A bereavement policy is available to all eligible employees that includes the following requirements:

- a. Protocol for notifying supervisors of the loss.

- b. Bereavement leave that includes:
 1. At least five days of paid leave during any 12-month period for the loss of a child (including miscarriages and stillbirths), spouse, parent or dependent.^{12,13}
 2. At least three days of leave, paid at 75% or higher of the employee's full salary or wages, during any 12-month period for the loss of a family member, colleague or friend.^{12,13}
 3. Additional unpaid leave for any of the above losses during any 12-month period, granting employees a minimum of 20 days of leave to use at any point in the bereavement process. The days of paid leave may be counted toward the 20 days.
- c. Bereavement support resources, covering:
 1. Coping with grief.
 2. Returning to work after a loss.^{8,14}
 3. Accessing local bereavement support services.^{8,14,15}
- d. Coverage for bereavement counseling services at no cost or subsidized by at least 50%.

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